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EXPERIMENT 2: SETTING UP A ZOHO CREATOR ACCOUNT AND EXPLORING THE PLATFORM ARCHITECTURE AND INTERFACE.

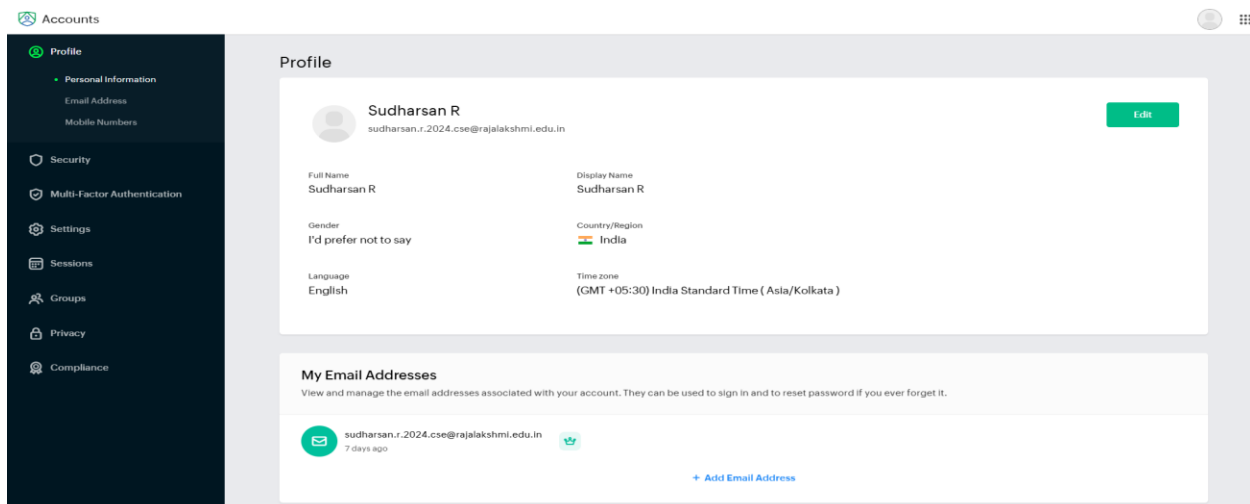
AIM:

To create a **Zoho Creator account**, develop a **sample application**, and explore the **architecture and user interface** of the Zoho Creator platform.

SETTING UP ZOHO CREATOR:

Step 1: Create a Zoho Creator Account:

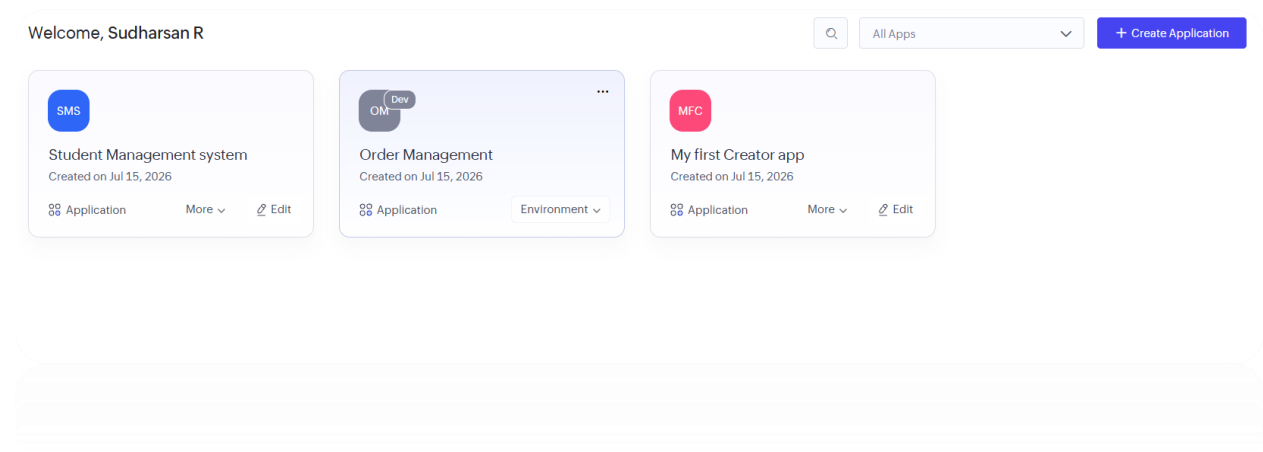
1. Open a web browser and visit <https://creator.zoho.com>.
2. Click **Sign Up**.
3. Register using an email address or sign in with a Google/Microsoft account.
4. Verify your email address (if required).
5. Log in to the Zoho Creator dashboard.
6. Choose the **Free Trial** or **Free Plan** to start creating applications.



a. Create a Sample Application

Steps

1. Click **Create New Application**.
2. Select **Blank Application**.
3. Enter the application name as **Student Management System**.
4. Click **Create**.
5. Add a new form named **Student Details**.
6. Insert the following fields:
 - a. Student ID
 - b. Student Name
 - c. Department
 - d. Email
 - e. Phone Number
7. Save the form.
8. Enter a few sample student records.
9. Create a report to display the stored records.
10. Create a dashboard to visualize the application data.



b. Screenshot of Form, Reports and Dashboard

Student details form:

The screenshot displays the 'Student Management system' interface. On the left is a dark sidebar with a menu containing 'Student details' (selected) and 'Student details Report'. The main area is titled 'Student details' and contains a form with the following fields:

- Name:** Two input fields for 'First Name' and 'Last Name'.
- Address:** Two input fields for 'Address Line 1' and 'Address Line 2'.
- City / District:** An input field.
- State / Province:** A dropdown menu with '-Select-' as the current selection.
- Postal Code:** An input field.
- Country:** A dropdown menu.
- Phone:** An input field with a country code dropdown set to '+91' and the number '81234 56789'.
- Email:** An input field.

A purple 'Submit' button is located at the bottom of the form. The top of the interface shows a header with 'Student Management system', navigation icons, and links for 'Trial expires in 8 days', 'Upgrade', 'Edit this application', and 'Help'. The bottom of the sidebar shows a user profile for 'Sudharsan R'.

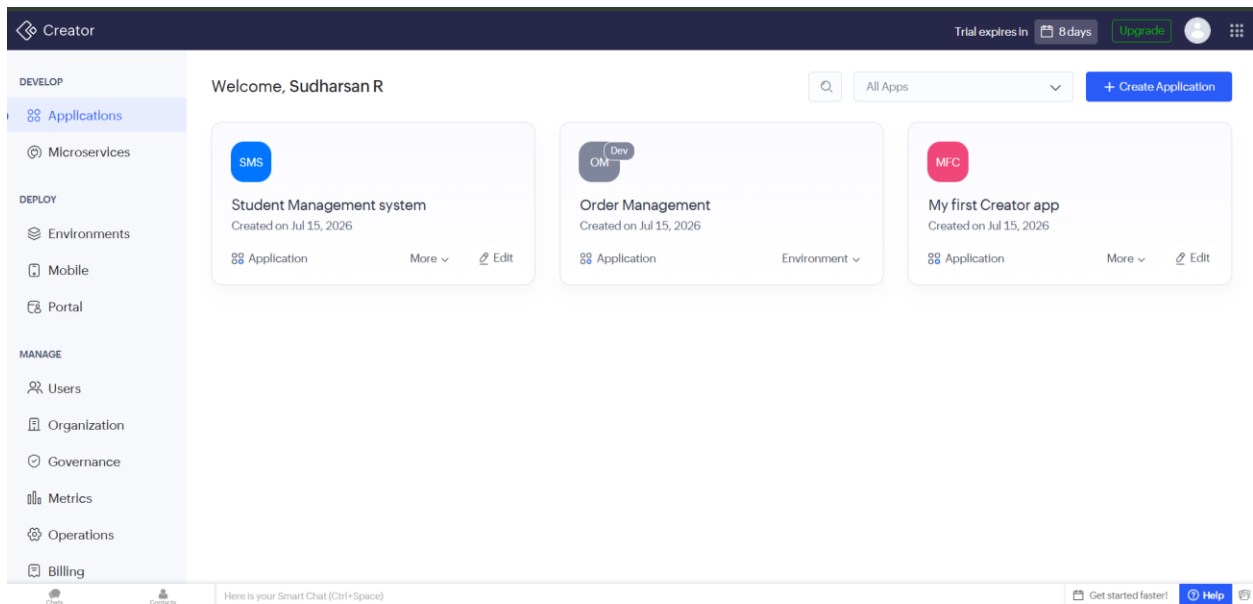
Student's Report:

The screenshot displays the 'Student Management system' interface with the 'Student details Report' view selected in the sidebar. The main area shows a table with the following data:

	Name	Address	Phone	Email
	Vishal Mc	1/50,parvathy st,mudichur,chennai, chennai, India	+918456193270	vehsal@gmail.com
	Sujit P	1/86,krishna st,pammal,chennai, chennai, India	+919856215236	sujit.26@gmail.com
	Sudharsan R	1/90,kss st,anna nagar,chennai, chennai, India		

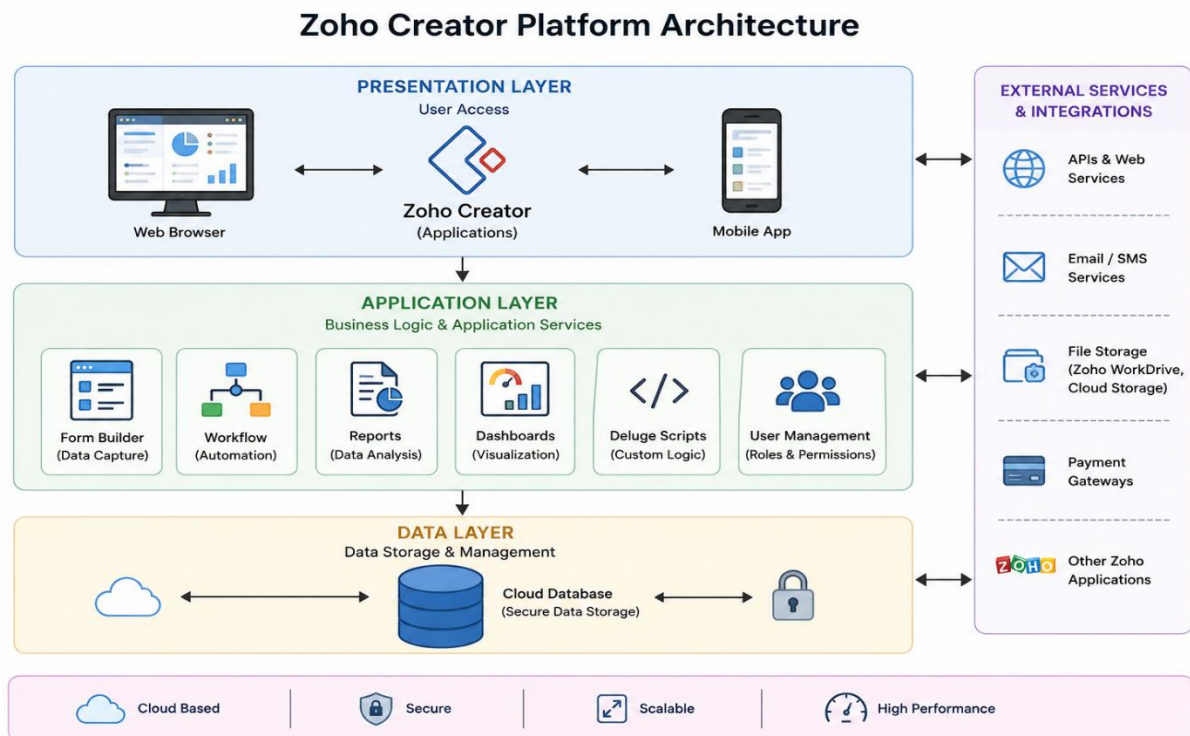
Below the table, it says 'Showing 3 of 3'. The top of the interface shows a header with 'Student Management system', navigation icons, and links for 'Trial expires in 8 days', 'Upgrade', 'Edit this application', and 'Help'. The bottom of the sidebar shows a user profile for 'Sudharsan R'.

Dashboard:



EXPLORE THE ARCHITECTURE AND INTERFACE:

a.) Zoho Creator Architecture



Zoho Creator follows a cloud-based three-tier architecture.

Architecture Components

1. Presentation Layer

- Provides the graphical user interface (GUI).
- Accessible through web browsers and mobile applications.
- Allows users to interact with forms, reports, and dashboards.

2. Application Layer

- Contains the business logic of the application.
- Includes:
 - Form Builder
 - Workflow Automation
 - Deluge Scripting
 - Reports
 - Dashboards

3. Data Layer

- Stores all application data securely in the cloud database.
- Retrieves and updates records whenever users perform operations.

b.) Zoho Creator Interface:

The Zoho Creator interface is simple and user-friendly. The major components include:

- Home Dashboard – Displays all created applications.
- Applications Panel – Lists available applications.
- Form Builder – Used to create data entry forms.
- Report Builder – Displays stored data in different report formats.
- Dashboard Builder – Creates graphical dashboards using charts.
- Workflow Section – Automates tasks and business processes.
- Settings – Used to manage users, permissions, and application configurations.



CONCLUSION:

A Zoho Creator account was successfully created, and a sample application was developed using forms, reports, and dashboards. The experiment also explored the cloud-based architecture and user-friendly interface of Zoho Creator. The platform enables rapid application development with minimal coding, making it suitable for business applications and workflow automation.